it is acted upon by several micro-organisms like bacteria, fungi or small insects in a time period. Biodegradable waste includes vegetable and fruit peels, leftover food and garden wastes (grass, leaves, weeds and twigs).

Natural elements like oxygen, water, moisture, and heat facilitate the decomposition thereby breaking complex organic forms to simpler units. Decomposed matter eventually mixes or returns back to the soil and thus the soil is once again nourished with various nutrients and minerals.

## Non-biodegradable waste

Those materials which cannot be broken down or decomposed into the soil by micro-organisms and natural agents are labeled as **non-biodegradable.** These substances consist of plastic materials, metal scraps, aluminum cans and bottles, etc.



These things are practically immune to the natural processes and thus cannot be fed upon or broken down even after thousands of years.

**Give some examples for Biodegradable and Non-biodegradable waste.**

| S. No. | Biodegradable waste | Non-bio-degradable waste |
|---|---|---|
| 1. | Food Waste | Plastic Bottles |
| 2. | | |
| 3. | | |
| 4. | | |
| 5. | | |

**Discuss with your teacher and friends.**

1. Are animal bones biodegradable?
   _____



2. Are all types of clothes biodegradable? _____

### Rani and her garbage

Rani gets home from school. She is hungry. She eats a banana and a packet of chips. She puts the banana peel and plastic chips packet into the waste bin. In the waste bin, the waste mixes together and the banana peel and makes the plastic chips packet dirty. The waste bin starts to smell and Rani's mother puts the waste outside on the street. The municipality collects the waste from outside Rani's house and many other houses in a tractor. The tractor drives to a big open dump and leaves all mixed wastes there.





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